bicycle taxis were targeted.[19] All of these actions targeted activities that were illegal, but had been widespread and tacitly tolerated.

Scholars and analysts offer four basic models for characterizing the shifts in Cuban economic policy in the 1990s and beyond. Mesa-Lago sees the current phase as a continuation of a cycle that has characterized Cuba's approach since the early days of the Revolution. Pragmatism (1970–86, 1993–96), where economic policies were more market-oriented, followed by periods of idealism (1960–70, 1986–93, 1996–present) where state control, moral incentives, and socialist ideals were emphasized. Eckstein argues, rather, that pragmatism has governed Cuban government policies all along, with idealism being mobilized to justify decisions taken for very pragmatic reasons – often because there were few other options. Corrales sees the post-2000 recentralization as proof that the market reforms were a false promise. Ritter portrays the process as more of a progression, with each new phase growing from new analyses of an evolving reality.

In some ways the debate over whether Cuba's policies are motivated by ideology or by pragmatism is a futile one. In every period, and in every country, a government's goals and beliefs are realized in the real world and within limits and structures beyond its control. No governing body is without an ideology, and no governing body can impose its ideology in a vacuum. Every governing body has adjusted and shifted its programs as circumstances have changed.

Even those who criticize the re-centralization admit that corruption was endemic in the dual economy – in some ways, built into it. "Self-employed workers generally obtain inputs from the black market, which in turn is largely fed by theft from the state sector," Díaz-Briquets and Pérez-López explain. They cite an example raised by Ana Julia Jatar-Hausmann, who describes how Jorge, a self-employed shoemaker, evaded directly answering the question of where he obtained his tools and equipment. "It is, in fact, a silly question," Jatar-Hausmann explains.

> Everybody knows that there are no free markets for any of the instruments used by Jorge; nor are there supplies for most of the products the artisans make. They either take them from their